

ready know you can find it cheaper somewhere else), and honestly, they have to be for the places to make a profit. It's good business. It's also good business for you to find one that carries your dress, try it on there, and get the size and any other information. It was a relief for me to know that the dress would fit when it came.

18. Look into dresses made out of different materials

Heavy satin is the most popular and, therefore, one of the most expensive materials right now. I ended up with a dress made out of taffeta, which was lighter (perfect for my more casual wedding) and cheaper, and made me feel like I belonged in a ballroom.

19. Find a seamstress who sews as a home-based business

People who do this are often cheaper, and can work around any scheduling difficulties you may have. I asked for recommendations at work, and found a woman who did all my alterations for \$100! (That's unheard of, in the wedding world.)

20. Avoid bridal chain stores

Seriously, it's tempting, but you can resist. Really. I have faith in you.

And you can most likely find what you're looking for somewhere else. If you truly can't, buy your dress there, but watch out for any other "special pricing" they may offer you on other items. The fact that your bridesmaids get 10% off their dresses because you bought yours there sounds good, but they'll still most likely be paying too much for their dresses. And alterations? Don't even get me started!

21. Make your own veil

It's easy. I promise. If you're worried, find a friend who can sew and get her to help. But really? It's cake. My best friend and I even did some hand-beading on mine, and that was easy, too.

22. Rent tuxes as a group—you'll get one free.

If you don't, go to another tux shop. Men's Wearhouse is, by the way, a great, easy place to rent quality tuxes.

CAKE

23. Club stores

Club stores will do decorating for you, and their cake doesn't taste bad (that, from the girl who doesn't like cake). They won't stack or do anything fancy,

